

Early Electronic Music

Late 1940s- Early 1960s

Thom Holmes Text

Thom Holmes textbook on Electronic & Experimental Music can be found here:

https://wm.primo.exlibrisgroup.com/permalink/01COWM_INST/11mjb00/cdi_proquest_ebookcentral_EBC181665

If you click on any of the chapters, it looks like the side bar will show up, so you can navigate through the whole book.

Playlist

<https://open.spotify.com/playlist/4upYY7rNlqvUncZHdCBiCX?si=ZE6l75PiSRWi1tkZ87Y5iw>

Tape Music: Musique Concrète GRM, France

Compositions made with turntables/tape from a variety of source material.

Pierre Schaeffer

Pierre Henry

Bernard Parmegiani

Luc Ferrari

**Tape Music:
Musique
Concrete
GRM, France**



Electronic music studio: WDR, Germany

Concepts drawn from serialism, "pure" electronic tones from synthesis

Stockhausen eventually combined WDR ideas and GRM

A lot of composers came through both GRM and WDR to experimental with electronics and tape.

Electronic studio: WDR, Germany



Tape, Electronics, and other Combinations

Other composers important to early electronic music:

Edgar Varese

John Cage (and Feldman, Brown, Wolff)

Louis & Bebe Barron

Daphne Oram

Iannis Xenakis

There are many others, as well.

Forbidden Planet



Synthesis: Moog & Buchla

Original Silver Apples from the Moon can be found on YouTube.

<https://youtu.be/EelvKqhu1M4?feature=shared>

Moog, popularized synthesizers with keyboards
Buchla, more experimental interfaces

Performers & composers important to early synths:
Morton Subotnick, Wendy Carlos

Creating electronic instruments that are "patchable"
to allow for composers to create their sounds from
(mostly) scratch.

Synthesis: Moog & Buchla



Computer Music

Laurie Spiegel*, John Chowning (FM synthesis & Yamaha DX7)

*Expanding Universe was written on the GROOVE system at Bell Labs <https://120years.net/groove-systems-max-mathews-usa-1970/>

Max Mathews, Bell Labs (Max/MSP was named after Max Mathews)

Applying computational concepts and synthesis to music, sound spatialization (stereo and more)

Computer Music

